

Shang Zhou

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EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego

Ph.D. in Computer Science

Advisor: Jingbo Shang

San Diego, CA

Sep 2025 – Dec 2028 (Expected)

University of California, San Diego

B.S. in Computer Science

Advisor: Jingbo Shang

San Diego, CA

Sep 2021 – Jun 2025

EXPERIENCE

Citadel Securities

Incoming Quantitative Research Intern

Miami, FL

Jun 2027 – Aug 2027

Jump Trading

Quantitative Research Intern

Chicago, IL

Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

- Hand-designed and systematically discovered novel signals for global futures; multiple adopted into production.
- Placed 1st in 6 of 8 intern-vs-intern mock trading game sessions (8 teams per session, reshuffled each session).

Esports Prediction Market Trading

Independent Project

San Diego, CA

May 2026 – Jun 2026

- Built an automated Kalshi trading system for LoL esports; dynamically fuses in-game features with market priors.
- Profited +4.7% ROI across 128 live trades despite ~20s extra delay vs. public stream and 7% one-way friction.

AutoCode

Research Lead

San Diego, CA

Jul 2025 – Sep 2025

- Built AutoCode for LLM-based competitive programming generation; 99% judge consistency vs. 81% SOTA.
- Licensed AutoCode datasets to an industry partner for \$100K+; quality verified by Grandmaster-level experts.

LiveCodeBench Pro

Research Lead

San Diego, CA

Mar 2025 – May 2025

- Co-led a team of 20 researchers from NYU, Princeton, UCSD, and UW to benchmark LLMs on ICPC problems.
- Quantified the major gap to Grandmasters: LLMs score 0% on hard problems and fail observation-heavy problems.

Codeforces

Problem Setter

Remote

Jan 2021 – Jul 2024

- Authored and prepared a Codeforces Div 1 + 2 contest for over 25,000 participants as the 18th independent setter.
- Ranked among the Top 100 contributors on Codeforces for high upvotes on contest problems and tutorials.

HONORS AND AWARDS

22nd Place, ICPC World Finals	2023
5th Place, ICPC North America Championship	2023, 2024
Champion, ICPC North America West Division	2023
Champion, ICPC NSA Challenge	2024
8th Place, USACO Open Contest, Platinum Division	2020
International Grandmaster, Codeforces	2022
3rd Place, S.-T. Yau High School Science Award (Mathematics)	2020
Featured in <i>MIT Technology Review</i> , for work on LiveCodeBench Pro	2025
7 Dan, American Go Association	2022
Champion, North American Ing Go Cup	2024
Champion, StarCraft II Grandmaster Tournament	2020
Rank 1 Legend, Hearthstone Standard Ladder	2018

PUBLICATIONS

- **AutoCode-RL: Reinforcement Learning for Code with Verifiable Synthetic Data**
Kaiyuan Liu, Zhiming Wang, Zeyu Shen, Yulun Wu, Yeyuan Chen, **Shang Zhou**, Qiuyang Mang, Mickel Liu, Zerui Cheng, Wenhao Chai, Tsai-chuan Wu, Burak Uzkent, Sharon Zhou, Luke Zettlemoyer, Natasha Jaques
Under review at *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2027
- **OpenDeepThink: Parallel Reasoning via Bradley-Terry Aggregation**
Shang Zhou, Wenhao Chai, Kaiyuan Liu, Huanzhi Mao, Qiuyang Mang, Jingbo Shang
Under review at *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2027
- **FrontierSmith: Synthesizing Open-Ended Coding Problems at Scale**
Runyuan He*, Qiuyang Mang*, **Shang Zhou**, Kaiyuan Liu, Hanchen Li, Huanzhi Mao, Qizheng Zhang, Zerui Li, Bo Peng, Lufeng Cheng, Tianfu Fu, Yichuan Wang, Wenhao Chai, Jingbo Shang, Alex Dimakis, Joseph E Gonzalez, Alvin Cheung
Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), 2026, **Spotlight**
- **FrontierCS: Evolving Challenges for Evolving Intelligence**
Qiuyang Mang*, Wenhao Chai*, Zhifei Li*, Huanzhi Mao*, **Shang Zhou***, et al. ... Jingbo Shang, Alvin Cheung
International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML), 2026
- **Terminal-Bench: Benchmarking Agents on Hard, Realistic Tasks in Command Line Interfaces**
Mike A Merrill*, Alexander Glenn Shaw*, Nicholas Carlini, et al. ... **Shang Zhou** ... Ludwig Schmidt
International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR), 2026
- **AutoCode: LLMs as Problem Setters for Competitive Programming**
Shang Zhou*, Zihan Zheng*, Kaiyuan Liu*, Zeyu Shen*, Zerui Cheng*, Zexing Chen, Hansen He, Jianzhu Yao, Huanzhi Mao, Qiuyang Mang, Tianfu Fu, Beichen Li, Dongruixuan Li, Wenhao Chai, Zhuang Liu, Aleksandra Korolova, Peter Henderson, Natasha Jaques, Pramod Viswanath, Saining Xie, Jingbo Shang
International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR), 2026
- **LiveCodeBench Pro: How Do Olympiad Medalists Judge LLMs in Competitive Programming?**
Zihan Zheng*, Zerui Cheng*, Zeyu Shen*, **Shang Zhou***, Kaiyuan Liu*, Hansen He*, Dongruixuan Li, Stanley Wei, Hangyi Hao, Jianzhu Yao, Peiyao Sheng, Zixuan Wang, Wenhao Chai, Aleksandra Korolova, Peter Henderson, Sanjeev Arora, Pramod Viswanath, Jingbo Shang, Saining Xie
Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), 2025
- **Scaling LLM Inference Efficiently with Optimized Sample Compute Allocation**
Kexun Zhang*, **Shang Zhou***, Danqing Wang, William Yang Wang, Lei Li
Nations of the Americas Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL), 2025
- **Evaluating the Smooth Control of Attribute Intensity in Text Generation with LLMs**
Shang Zhou*, Feng Yao*, Chengyu Dong, Zihan Wang, Jingbo Shang
Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2024

INVITED TALKS

<i>AutoCode: LLMs as Problem Setters for Competitive Programming</i>	Nov 2025
NVIDIA, LLM Reasoning Team	
<i>Guest Lecture: LLMs in Competitive Programming</i>	Mar 2026
UCSD CSE 109: Intro to Programming Contests	